

FOLIO INTERACTIVE

Brand Style Guide

Version 2.0 — April 2026

Confidential — Internal Use Only

Where wonder takes traction.

This document is the locked source of truth for all Folio Interactive brand decisions. No downstream asset — visual, verbal, or structural — should contradict it. All decisions trace to three upstream locked files: strategy-folio-v2, visual-identity-folio-v2, and voice-folio-v2.

1. Brand Overview

One-Line Description

Folio Interactive builds adaptive educational software that meets learners where they are, challenges them to think deeply, and equips educators with tools that flex to any classroom.

Mission Statement

To make rigorous, personalized learning accessible — software that adapts to the learner, illuminates the path forward, and builds the confidence to keep going.

Founding Principle

"Could you patent the sun?" — Jonas Salk

The base product is free. Always. Structural, not aspirational.

Tagline

Where wonder takes traction.

Brand Archetype

Archetype	Role	Function
Primary: The Sage	Knowledge & truth	Calm authority, intellectual depth, earns trust through competence.
Secondary: The Caregiver	Patience & presence	Attuned to struggle, present during difficulty. Prevents the Sage from feeling cold.

Brand Personality

In priority order: Adaptive · Purposeful · Illuminating · Principled · Empowering

Voice References

Bill Nye · Neil deGrasse Tyson · Michael Stevens (VSauce) · Alex Trebek · Ken Jennings

Enthusiastic, grounded, intellectually humble, patient, never dumbed-down.

Positioning Statement

For K-12 learners and educators who need more than passive instruction, Folio Interactive is the adaptive learning platform that teaches students how to think — not just what to know — because mastery is built through doing, not watching.

Target Audiences

Priority	Audience	Description
Primary	Independent Learner	Curious, self-motivated K-12. Wants to go deeper or faster than the classroom allows.

Priority	Audience	Description
Secondary	Classroom Educator	K–12 teacher or administrator. Values credibility, outcomes, ease of deployment.
Tertiary	Engaged Parent / College Learner	Seeking enrichment or subject depth beyond lecture.

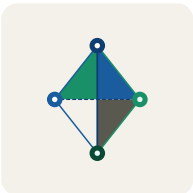
2. Logo & Mark

The Mark — Diamond Form

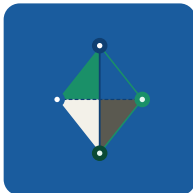
The Folio Interactive mark is a four-faced diamond built from four node points. Each face carries a brand color. The vertical spine is Deep Blue. The dotted horizontal back edge implies depth. Four outer nodes anchor the form.



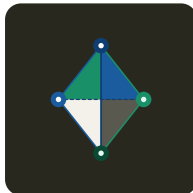
On White



On Parchment



On Atlas Blue



On Ink

Wordmark Lockup



Folio
INTERACTIVE



INTERACTIVE

Wordmark Specification

Element	Typeface	Weight	Color
"Folio"	Source Serif 4	600 Bold	Atlas Blue #1A5C9E
"INTERACTIVE"	Barlow	500 Medium	Slate #5A5950 — tracked wide

Logo Rules

Rule	Specification
Clear space	Minimum equal to height of the 'F' in Folio on all sides. More critical on Parchment backgrounds where lower-left face blends.
Minimum size	Mark + wordmark: 120px wide minimum. Favicon / mark only: 48px minimum.
Approved backgrounds	White (#FFFFFF), Parchment (#F3F1E9), Atlas Blue (#1A5C9E), Ink (#28281F). No others without explicit approval.
Never	Rotate, distort, recolor, add effects, or use on busy photographic backgrounds.
Never	Substitute fonts in the wordmark or alter node positions or face colors in the mark.

3. Color System

Primary — Trust & Authority

#1A5C9E	Atlas Blue	Primary actions, navigation, headings	FFFFFF
#0F3F72	Deep Atlas	Hover states, emphasis	FFFFFF
#EAF4FC	Sky Tint	Backgrounds, highlights	0F3F72

Secondary — Mastery & Growth

#1A9068	Sage Teal	Success, mastery, progress	FFFFFF
#0A4A35	Deep Sage	Confirmed mastery, completion	FFFFFF
#E6F8F2	Mint Tint	Correct answers, encouragement	0A4A35

Accent — Attention & Warmth

#B56A10	Warm Amber	Alerts, nudges, in-progress	FFFFFF
#FDF3E0	Honey Tint	Hint areas, soft warnings	5C3205

Neutrals — Structure & Space

#28281F	Ink	Body text, primary content	FFFFFF
#5A5950	Slate	Secondary text, captions	FFFFFF
#D1CFC4	Warm Gray	Borders, dividers	28281F
#F3F1E9	Parchment	Page backgrounds, card fills	28281F

Extended States

#C0392B	Error	Wrong answer state	FFFFFF
#FCECEA	Error Tint	Wrong answer background	7B1C12
#C9A800	Yellow	Near-miss, partial credit	28281F
#FFF9D6	Yellow Tint	Partial credit background	5C4200
#6B4EAA	Depth	Advanced concepts	FFFFFF
#F0ECFA	Depth Tint	Deep concept background	3D2172
#B5477A	Inference	Learner VARK data layer	FFFFFF
#FCEE55	Inference Tint	Learner profile background	6B1A44

Stubbed — Future Use

#C9A800	Yellow	No semantic role — stubbed	28281F
#FFF9D6	Yellow Tint	No semantic role — stubbed	28281F

Semantic Mapping

Color	Semantic Role
Blue	Authority / Navigation
Teal	Progress / Mastery
Amber	Attention / Encouragement
Red	Error / Wrong Answer
Yellow	Partial Credit / Near-Miss
Purple	Advanced Concept Depth
Pink	Learner Inference / VARK Data
Neutrals	Structure / Space

All text/background combinations meet WCAG AA minimum. AAA achieved on all tint combinations.

4. Typography

Type Pairing

Source Serif 4 (serif) carries editorial authority at heading scale. Barlow (sans-serif) delivers legibility and warmth at UI and body scale. Both are available via Google Fonts at no cost. Source Serif 4 replaces Lora from v1 — screen-optimized, reference-work in character.

Type Scale

Role	Font	Size / Weight	Usage
Display / H1	Source Serif 4	32px / 600	Hero text, module titles, major headings
H2	Source Serif 4	20px / 500	Section headers, lesson titles, card headings
Body / Subheading	Barlow	16px / 400 1.7lh	Lesson content, instructions, explanations
UI Labels / Nav	Barlow	14px / 500-600	Navigation, buttons, labels, form fields
Captions / Meta	Barlow	12px / 400	Timestamps, module metadata, footnotes

Usage Rules

- Source Serif 4 is used for headings only — never body copy or UI labels.
- Barlow replaces Helvetica Neue or Arial in all digital contexts.
- Minimum body: 16px. Minimum caption: 12px. Never go below 12px in any UI context.
- Two Barlow weights only: 400 (regular) and 500–600 (medium/semibold). Avoid 700+.
- Line height — body: 1.7. Headings: 1.2–1.35.
- Grade-responsive type scale (K–5, 6–8, 9–12): stubbed — Phase 2.
- DM Serif Display: stubbed as future display-only option for hero contexts.

5. Tone Spectrum

Folio's tone is defined across six axes. 0 = fully left pole, 100 = fully right pole. Folio default positions reflect the brand overall. Context overrides apply per situation.

Axis Definitions & Folio Defaults

Axis	Left (0)	Right (100)	Folio Default
Formal — Casual	Formal	Casual	30 — leans formal, structured not stiff
Serious — Playful	Serious	Playful	25 — leans serious, levity earns its place
Authoritative — Humble	Authoritative	Humble	40 — balanced, earns authority, admits limits
Warm — Reserved	Warm	Reserved	35 — leans warm, present not effusive
Precise — Expansive	Precise	Expansive	25 — leans precise, specificity over elaboration
Direct — Exploratory	Direct	Exploratory	45 — near center, answers clearly, invites further

Context-Specific Overrides

Axis	Wrong Ans.	Mastery	Onboardin g	Instructor	Hint
Formal — Casual	35	40	45	20	42
Serious — Playful	20	35	40	15	28
Authoritative — Humble	35	45	50	75	52
Warm — Reserved	35	30	40	75	25
Precise — Expansive	20	30	35	15	38
Direct — Exploratory	35	50	55	20	62

Hint is warmest and most exploratory. Instructor UI is most formal and precise. Wrong answer prioritizes diagnostic precision with Caregiver warmth retained.

6. Voice & Copy Rules

Vocabulary — Use

Action Verbs

build, explore, practice, notice, connect, demonstrate, try, apply, strengthen, reflect, trace, distinguish, locate, classify, compare, verify, account for

Nouns & Framing Words

mastery, pattern, evidence, understanding, reasoning, mechanism, precision

VARK Pattern Language — Student-Facing

shown more confidence with · stronger results from · questions like this have been trickier · worth spending more time with · a pattern worth noticing

Vocabulary — Avoid

General

leverage, unlock, crush it, easy, simply, just, fail, wrong, optimize, seamless, robust, innovative

VARK Pattern — Never Use

you struggle with (as pattern characterization) · you're weak at · you're not a [type label] · your learning style · this format is hard for you · you consistently get wrong

Copy Rules by Context

Context	Rules
Onboarding	Welcome without fanfare. Lead with what the student will do. Max 2 sentences per screen. Never promise 'easy.'
Wrong answer	Never say 'wrong' or 'incorrect.' Say what the answer reveals. Redirect to reasoning. Neutral, not cheerful.
Struggle	Acknowledge difficulty honestly. Redirect to pattern or strategy. Never 'almost!' or 'so close!' — say what they got right.
Mastery	Name what was demonstrated specifically. One exclamation point maximum. Connect forward.
Hint	Point toward a direction, not a destination. Caregiver leads. Warmest context in the system.
Instructor UI	Direct and efficient. Lead with action or data. Respect expertise — don't over-explain.
Marketing	Lead with the differentiator. Avoid generic claims. Make a specific claim and back it with a mechanism.

Phrase Guidance

Prefer	Avoid
Let's look at what happened	You got it wrong

Prefer	Avoid
Notice what these have in common	The answer is...
You demonstrated mastery of...	Great job! You passed!
This builds on what you know	Before we begin...
Could you explain this to someone else?	Do you understand?
Try a different approach	That's not right, try again
Here's what the data shows	You're doing great!
This is a tricky one	This should be easy

7. Grade Register

The phrase 'What's the big idea here?' is universal and verbatim across all grade bands. Voice shifts across five dimensions per band: sentence construction, vocabulary ceiling, tone calibration, formatting, and the Big Idea Callback.

9-12 — Full Specification

Dimension	9-12 Specification
Sentence construction	Short setup + medium explanation + short landing. Em dashes extend a thought. Medium-high complexity — serves precision, not decoration.
Vocabulary	Plain language leads. Technical term follows at moment of need, defined inline once. 9th grade baseline. Ceiling rises with student.
Tone contract	Students addressed as capable reasoners. Never pre-apologize for difficulty. No false stakes. Metacognitive prompts explicit and direct.
Formatting	Prose leads. Lists earn their place when content is sequential, multi-element, or order conveys importance.
VARK	Pattern surfaced as observation, not verdict. Scenario-anchored metacognitive prompts.

6-8 — Directional Stub

Caregiver leads more. Shorter sentences. Slower technical vocabulary introduction. Metacognitive prompts more scaffolded. Peer contexts over workplace framings. Visual anchors more load-bearing.

Full spec deferred to when 6-8 content enters the build pipeline.

K-5 — Directional Stub

Caregiver leads. Sage recedes. Short, direct sentences. Wonder hook does more work. Technical terms deferred until concept is fully concrete. Text supports artifacts, not the other way around.

Full spec deferred to when K-5 content enters the build pipeline.

8. The Big Idea Callback

"What's the big idea here?" — universal, verbatim, across all grade bands. One passive instance and one active instance per module. Fixed.

Module Arc

Fundamentals
|
V
"What's the big idea here?" (passive — Folio shows)
|
V
Analogy OR Worked Example (context-dependent)
|
V
Practice
|
V
"What's the big idea here?" (active — student shows)

Analogy vs. Worked Example

Does the concept have a strong real-world analogy?
YES --> Use analogy. Example: projection distortion = peeling an orange flat.
NO --> Is the concept procedural or multi-step?
YES --> Use worked example. Example: scale bar distance calculation.
NO --> Move directly to practice.

9-12 Examples

Passive (mid-module — Folio answers)

What's the big idea here? Every map is a lie — a controlled distortion. The question isn't which map is accurate. It's which distortion serves your purpose.

Active (EIB prompt — student answers)

What's the big idea here? Imagine your group has been asked to present a project on global shipping routes. Your team needs to pick one map projection. Walk through it: (1) Which projection would you choose — and what does it get right? (2) What does your chosen projection distort — and does that matter for shipping routes? (3) How would you explain that trade-off to your group if someone pushed back? There's no single right answer. The reasoning is the evidence.

6–8 and K–5 active callback examples deferred to when those grade bands enter the build pipeline.

9. Messaging Pillars

You're seen here.

Every learner is different. The software adapts — it doesn't make the student adapt to it.

"Folio adjusts to how you learn, not the other way around."

Mastery is built, not given.

Understanding comes through doing, not watching. Every interaction is practice, not performance.

"You don't just read about forces. You apply them, test them, and explain them back."

Struggle is part of the process.

Difficulty signals learning in progress. The platform treats errors as data, not failures.

"Getting it wrong the first time is how you find out what you actually know."

Curiosity compounds.

One concept connects to another. The goal is to make students want to go further.

"This module ends here. The question it leaves you with doesn't."

Think about your thinking.

Metacognition is a skill. Students learn not just the subject, but how they learn it.

"Could you explain this to someone who's never heard of it? Try."

10. Competitive Position

Differentiation Statement

Khan Academy delivers breadth. Folio builds depth — through a spiral curriculum that keeps prior knowledge active, kinetic artifacts that make concepts tangible, and diagnostic feedback that treats every wrong answer as a map to what the student actually needs next.

Comparison

Khan Academy	Folio Interactive
Linear curriculum	Spiral — prior concepts in every module
Recall and procedure	Reasoning — questions target why, not what
Passive video + static questions	Kinetic artifacts and interactive components
Generic wrong-answer feedback	Diagnostic — identifies the specific misconception
No learner inference layer	Tracks question-format strengths and weaknesses
Content breadth over depth	Encyclopedic depth at grade register
Fixed scaffolding	Scaffold withdraws as mastery builds

Anti-Positioning

- *Gamified entertainment masquerading as education*
- *A passive video lecture platform*
- *Quirky, casual, or trend-chasing in tone or design*
- *A one-size curriculum with rigid pacing*
- *A replacement for the teacher — a force multiplier for them*
- *Generic in its claims ('engaging,' 'powerful,' 'seamless')*
- *A content library. Breadth without depth is not mastery.*

11. Vision

Year One Success

A complete, comprehensive World Geography module at full 9th-grade course depth. Every topic covered, every concept verified, spiral architecture fully functional. Pilot tested with real students. Ready to transfer the infrastructure to a second subject — not starting it, ready for it.

Five-Year Vision

Phase	Description
Phase 1 — Infrastructure	Prove the spiral engine, artifact system, diagnostic pipeline, and encyclopedic standard transfer between subjects.
Phase 2 — Depth	History, Earth Science, Physics built on proven infrastructure. Depth before breadth, always.
Audience	Independent learner primary. Institutional adoption optional — not ruled out, never the primary design constraint.
Barometer	A second subject live and functional is the proof of concept for everything that follows.

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